

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

If you had had a choice ...



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Would you have had a better life if you had lived in another era?
- How would your personality have been different if you had been born in another time?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about emotions, opinions, behavior and work.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations in the past.
- I can talk about what I wish for in the past, present or future.





Let's Explore!

If Vanessa could go back to the **New Orleans Jazz Era***

* The "New Orleans Jazz Era" began in 1910 and is a combination of ragtime, blues and brass band music.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Do you ever wonder what it would have been like if you had been born in a different era?
- Vanessa:** If I had been born in another time period I wouldn't have come to America.
- Sally:** Why not?
- Vanessa:** There wouldn't have been the means of communication or transportation that there is now. I think those things make it easier for people to move around because you can easily and immediately travel or communicate with people overseas. They made it easier for me.
- Sally:** True. Sometimes I wish I lived in a different country. I wish I spoke another language.
- Vanessa:** You still can. Hey, Peter!
- Peter:** What's up? It's awful outside!
- Vanessa:** What's bugging you? You look grumpy.
- Peter:** Can't you see I'm drenched? I wish I had had my umbrella! The weatherman should have said rain, if he had known! Can't trust those guys!
- Sally:** Hey Pete! If you had had the choice when would you have chosen to be born?
- Peter:** That's a ludicrous question. I can't even fathom being born at another point in time.
- Vanessa:** Don't be such a stick in the mud. Maybe if you had lived in another era you would have been a lot happier.
- Sally:** Sometimes I wish we could go back to the Jazz Era in New Orleans.
- Vanessa:** Ohh that does sound rather intriguing! If I had been given a choice, I would have also picked that time and place. Imagine we would have worn all those lovely drop-waist dresses.
- Peter:** As much as this is a stupid conversation, that is a super cool idea!
- Sally:** That's it Peter. Let your imagination blossom!



Let's Practice!

Peter appears to be in a foul mood.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect word. Write the correct word above to complete the sentence. Use capital letters where necessary. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Can't you see I'm trenched?

2. Don't be such a stig in the mud.

3. That's a ludicrous question.

4. What's buging you? You look grampy.

5. As much as this is a stiped conversation, that is a super cool idea!



Let's Practice!

What is the group dreaming about?

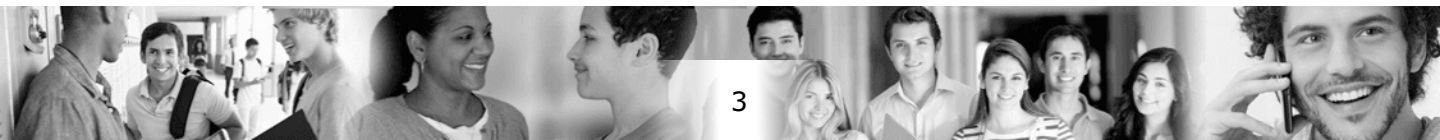
Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. wish / back / I / New / in / Orleans / go / Era / to / the / Jazz / could /
Sometimes / . / we

2. umbrella / ! / I / wish / I / my / had / had

3. Different / in / wish / I / Sometimes / lived / a / country / . / I

4. spoke / language / . / I / I / another / wish





Extension Activity

Research a different time in history and write about how life would have been if you had lived then.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research a specific period of time in history online.
- Write about how your life would have been different if you had been born at that time.
- Share your reading with a partner.
- Ask your partner to share his/her ideas.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I research an era in the past.

☐ ☐

I write about a hypothetical situation in the past.

☐ ☐

I share my writing about a period in time.

☐ ☐

I talk about a hypothetical situation in the past.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to bug** (verb): annoy or bother
e.g. What's bugging you?
- **grumpy** (adjective): unhappy and bad-tempered
e.g. You look grumpy.
- **drenched** (adjective): to be wet
e.g. Can't you see I'm drenched?
- **ludicrous** (adjective): unreasonable or out of place
e.g. That's a ludicrous question.
- **a stick in the mud** (expression): a person who resists change
e.g. Don't be such a stick in the mud.
- **intriguing** (adjective): very interesting or fascinating
e.g. That does sound rather intriguing.
- **drop-waist** (adjective): a style of waistline on a dress cut so that the seam is positioned at the hips rather than the waist
e.g. We could have worn all those lovely drop-waist dresses.
- **blossom** (verb): to develop successfully
e.g. Let your imagination blossom!





Learning Points

The Third Conditional - Talking Hypothetically About the Past

When talking about unreal situations in the past, the third conditional is used.

The third conditional is used to talk about past regrets. You can use *would have*, *should have* and *could have* to discuss hypothetical situations in the past.

Could have is used to represent that a past action was possible and that the user could have done something, but didn't.

Example: We **could have heard** Prince play!

Should have is used to represent regret about something that was done or not done in the past.

Example: We **should have studied** harder for the exam!

Should have can also be used to offer someone advice.

Example: You **should have studied** harder for the exam!

Would have is used in the past to represent something that didn't occur.

Example: Maybe if you had lived in another era you **would have been** a lot happier.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the third conditional:

Conditional Name	Structure	Example
Third	If + Past Perfect, could/should/would (not) have + past participle	If I had been born in another time period I wouldn't have come to America.

Notice the position of *not*. It comes between the two auxiliary verbs.

Examples:

- *There wouldn't have been the means of communication or transportation that there is now.*
- *If you had had the choice when would you have chosen to be born?*
- *If I had been given a choice, I would have also picked that time and place.*
- *We could have heard Prince play!*
- *We should have studied harder for the exam!*
- *Imagine we could have worn all those lovely drop-waist dresses.*





Learning Points

Talking about Wishes

You use *wish*, plus the past form of the verb or the past participle of the verb to talk about imaginary situations in the past, present or future.

Wishes and sentences in the second and third conditional infer that what you want or wanted is probably not possible, or for some reason impossible and that you regret what happened in the past.

You use wish + Simple Past to talk about wishes in the present or future.

For example:

*Sometimes I **wish I lived** in a different country.*

(I don't live in a different country.)

You use wish + had + past participle to talk about wishes about past situations.

For example:

*I **wish I had had** my umbrella!*

(I didn't have my umbrella.)

Examples:

- *Sometimes I wish I lived in a different country.*
- *I wish I spoke another language.*
- *I wish I had had my umbrella!*
- *I wish we could go back to the Jazz Era in New Orleans.*

